Semis Take The Tape

S&P +0.79% to record 7,164. Nasdaq +1.63% all-time high. Intel halo lifts AMD +13.91%, QCOM +11.12%. Iran talks resume in Islamabad.

THE SESSION

Intel's after-close print did exactly what the morning brief flagged it would do. Thursday's blowout from the chipmaker — EPS of $0.29 versus a penny consensus, Q2 revenue guided to a $14.3 billion midpoint against $13.0 billion Street — detonated the entire semiconductor complex on the open and never let go. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index crossed 10,000 for the first time. AMD ripped 13.91% to $347.81 on a D.A. Davidson upgrade to Buy with a $375 target, the analyst writing that CPUs are "reinserting" themselves as foundational to the AI buildout as agentic workloads broaden compute demand beyond GPUs. QCOM, the dividend sleeve's most-pressured chip name coming into the session, rallied 11.12% to $148.85 — a clean rebuttal to the Barclays Underweight thesis the brief had flagged as the cleanest counter-point to take. TSM added 5.17%, NVDA gained 4.32%, CRDO climbed 5.12%, and LRCX advanced 3.57%.

The other thread the brief framed — the weekend Iran escalation window — began closing rather than opening. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi confirmed travel to Islamabad to meet Pakistani mediators on a second round of US negotiations, and the energy-premium tape that defined Thursday partially unwound. WTI pulled back below $95 even as Brent held above $105. Inside IOWN, the energy sleeve gave back: CVX eased 1.27%, VLO held its bid at +0.86% on continued refining-margin strength. The defense sleeve traded weak in sympathy with the talks momentum — LMT extended Thursday's miss damage at –3.08% to $513.45, and GD declined 1.73% to $313.21. The dispersion that defined Thursday inverted: defensive sectors that led yesterday's tape lagged today, and the AI-capex names that absorbed selling reclaimed leadership.

The S&P closed at a record 7,164.29. The Nasdaq printed a fresh all-time high of 24,836.60. The Dow finished modestly red at −0.16% on the defensive rotation reversal. VIX fell 3.42% to 18.65. Michigan Sentiment's one-year inflation expectation came in at 4.7 versus 4.8 consensus — a narrow miss to the cool side that softened the fear of cost-push transmission to household psychology, and a constructive setup heading into next week's April 28–29 FOMC meeting. The week ends with the S&P up roughly 0.6% and the Nasdaq up 1.5%, both indices having fully recovered the Iran-war drawdown and now extended past prior highs.

IOWN Tactical: a tape where chip names lead records back while energy and defense unwind tells the committee where capital is being repositioned. The AI-capex thread is broadening, not narrowing.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

AMD +13.91% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at $347.81 — a record. D.A. Davidson upgraded to Buy from Neutral with target raised to $375 from $220, citing Intel's Q1 print as proof that x86 CPU demand is accelerating across the AI buildout. Stifel and BofA also lifted targets. Earnings May 5.

QCOM +11.12% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $148.85, reclaiming the 50-day moving average the morning brief flagged as the technical reference. Intel halo overcame the Apple modem and China-handset overhangs heading into Wednesday's Q2 print. Polymarket pricing 93% probability of consensus beat.

TSM +5.17% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $402.46 as the foundry beneficiary of the broader AI-capex re-rate. The semi-cap and foundry stack — LRCX, NXPI, ADI — moved as one cohort on the Intel print read-through.

CRDO +5.12% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $195.04. Roth's Suji Desilva grouped CRDO explicitly with AMD, MRVL, and ALAB as the AI-infrastructure names that should re-rate alongside Intel's validated demand cycle.

VST +4.78% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $164.35. Power-and-data-center demand thread continued to deliver. Pairs with NEE's 6.94% Thursday print as evidence the data-center electricity demand thesis is durable.

NVDA +4.32% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $208.27 as the broader chip complex carried the leader higher. Pyth Network/Kalshi prediction-market settlement deal added incremental crypto-infra optionality.

DECLINERS

HRMY –3.99% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $30.80. Specialty-pharma weakness on no fresh company news; the small-cap healthcare cohort gave back on the day's rotation away from defensives.

SSNC –3.95% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $67.29. Continued post-earnings drift after Thursday's narrow EPS beat at $1.69 versus $1.68 failed to convince. The bar in this regime requires acceleration, not delivery.

LMT –3.08% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $513.45, extending Thursday's 4.62% miss-driven decline. The defense sleeve traded weak as Iran-talks momentum reduced near-term geopolitical premium. The Q1 free-cash-flow deterioration remains the specific item to track.

HUT –2.41% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $76.87 as Bitcoin slipped 0.81% to $77,647 and the digital-asset equity-proxies traded heavy. IBIT held flat at −0.07% — the structural ETF bid has remained more resilient than the equity sleeve.

EIX –2.10% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $68.86. Utility rotation reversed sharply after Thursday's XLU-led defensive bid. The rate-sensitive sub-sleeve gave back as risk-on flows returned to chips.

HOLDINGS NEWS

QCOM Q2 FY26 earnings Wednesday April 29. Polymarket pricing a 93% probability of a beat against the $2.55 non-GAAP EPS consensus. The committee should treat this as the cleanest near-term test of whether the Intel-driven CPU/edge-AI thesis broadens to mobile silicon, or whether the Apple modem displacement and China handset weakness reassert. Management commentary on the Snapdragon X Elite PC ramp and the Apple C1/C2 modem timeline will move the stock more than the headline number.

CAT CFO Andrew Bonfield announced retirement. Caterpillar disclosed Bonfield's planned departure with the company beginning a search for a successor. CAT closed −0.53% to $830.79 on the day. CFO transitions at industrial bellwethers warrant tracking through the Q1 print expected next week, particularly the dealer inventory commentary that has driven recent guidance.

AMD reports Q1 2026 results May 5. Company-guided revenue near $9.8 billion, approximately 32% year-over-year growth. The Instinct MI400-series traction commentary will determine whether today's Intel-halo move converts to a fundamental re-rate or fades back into the QCOM-style positioning unwind. Data Center segment was already running at $5.38 billion in the most recent quarter, up 39% year-over-year.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

–0.13%

vs. DVY –0.89% | SPY +0.78%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

+1.21%

vs. IUSG +1.52%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +10.97% vs DVY +7.63% / SPY +4.70%
Growth +6.60% vs IUSG +5.72%